

W01 Learning Activity: Working with Files and Folders

Overview

It is critical for Software Developers to understand files, folders, and file paths at a deep level. In this course, you will use many files to create a single website and you need to be comfortable working with them and know the relationship among them.

This activity will review file path essentials and define the file [naming conventions](#) that you need to follow in this course.

File Path Essentials

File paths refer to the way we locate a file in a file system and your website uses file paths to link to files such as images and stylesheets. If a referenced asset, such as an image file, does not show up on your page either locally on your computer or when you publish it to GitHub Pages, you should check the file and file path.

The words **directory** and **folder** have essentially the same meaning. You will see both terms used in WDD courses and throughout industry.

Common File Path Examples

Absolute Paths

An absolute path gives the full path to a file and is used for external resources. When using absolute paths on the web, the path should begin with the protocol, such as **https://**. Absolute paths for a resource are always the same, regardless of where the source file is located.

The following example uses an absolute path for an image found on an external site:

```
** anchor tag.

```
About Us<a>
```

Notice that the file path does not begin with a protocol which means that the file path is relative to the html that contains the tag. Because the file path does not begin with a period **.** or a slash **/**, the computer will expect to find the **about-us.html** page in the same directory as the file that is referencing it.

Another method that can be used to reference the current directory is to use the **./** notation at the beginning of the path. The following example is equivalent to the earlier one—they both look for the file **about-us.html** in the current directory.

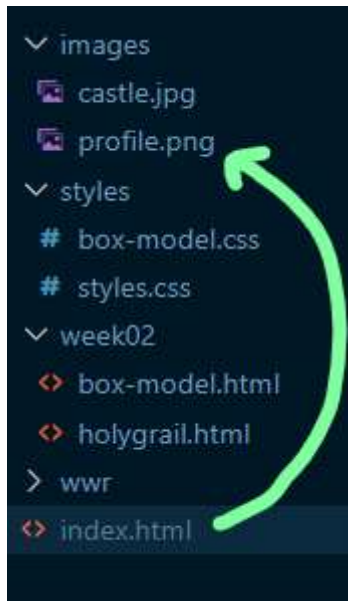
```
About Us<a>
```

## Relative Path: File in subfolder

The following example references an image named **profile.png** in a sub-folder named **images** (where the **images** folder is in the same main folder as the source html file.).

```

```



## Relative Path: A folder that is located at in a parent or higher folder

In this example, a file in the **week02** folder references an image named **castle.jpg**, but this image is in an **images** folder that is located at the root level (a level higher than the **week02** folder).

The **../** notation is used to go **up** a folder.

```
, \, /, #, ?, !, _**

- ✓ File and folder names should be as short and meaningful (**semantic**) as possible.

Short names save you, other developers, and site visitors from having to remember long complicated names for files and folders. When meaningful, names can also help predict the purpose or nature of the file or folder contents.

✗ Invalid example: **image13-v123523brokenbranchlifeimagery w200x200.png**

✓ Valid example: **winter-scene-small.png**

- ✓ Use standard names for folders. In this class, the **standard folder names** for sub-folders are:

- **styles** – Folders with this name contain CSS files.
- **images** – Folders with this name contain images.

Activity Instructions

Part 1: Naming Convention Review

Look at each of the following files and folders and determine if they follow the course naming conventions.

1. **About.html**

► Answer

2. **company information.html**

► Answer

3. **product-display.jpg**

► Answer

4. **train_schedule.html**

► Answer

5. **product4.png**

► Answer

6. **temple-large (copy).webp**

► Answer

Part 2: Practicing File Paths

This activity will help you practice relative and absolute file paths.

You will open an html file that has three images of temples. The **img** tags are already there and they have the correct filename, but they are missing the rest of the path information needed to make them appear. You need to update the **src** attribute of each of these **img** tags to get them to display on the page.

1. In VS Code, open your **wdd130** course repository folder.
2. Browse to the **week01** folder and open the file **file-paths.html** file.

3. Right-click on the file name and open it with Live/Five Server to see it in your browser. Notice that the three temple images are not working:

File path activity

Fix the image tags below so that they each display the correct image.

A temple in the images subfolder:

The Aba Nigeria Temple

A temple in the root images folder:

The Salt Lake Temple

A temple with an absolute path:

The Anchorage Alaska Temple

A screenshot showing the missing temple images.

4. Locate and fix the **img** tag for the following examples:

- ✓ **aba-nigeria-temple.jpeg**: This file is located in the images subfolder.
(Hint: You need to add this subfolder to the src attribute to go with the filename that is already there.)
- ✓ **salt-lake-temple.jpg**: This file is located in the images folder that is at the root level of the repository.
(Hint: You will need to go up one directory first in the file path.)
- ✓ **aba-nigeria-temple.jpeg**: This file is located on the web at this location:
<https://content.churchofjesuschrist.org/templesldsorg/bc/Temples/photo-galleries/anchorage-alaska/320x180/anchorage-temple-lds-253274-wallpaper.jpg>
(Hint: You should not download this file, but instead should refer to it directly using this full absolute path.)

When finished, your page should show all three temples as follows:

File path activity

Fix the image tags below so that they each display the correct image.

A temple in the images subfolder:



A temple in the root images folder:



A temple with an absolute path:



The completed activity, showing the temple images.

Submission

You do not need to submit anything yet for this learning activity. You can post questions and discuss with your peers and the instructor in the **Week 01 Forum**

channel in Microsoft Teams.

When you have finished the remaining learning activities for this week, you will return to Canvas to report on your progress.

Next: Publishing Your Pages to GitHub

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